

Food Image System — Read-Only Audit Review

Eat & Cheat · Image pipeline halted · no database writes · generated 2026-09-09

Scope: all 733 **active** foods. Sources read: `postgresql` (read-only `SELECT`), `scripts/.food_image_results.json` (461 Pass-1 records), `scripts/.food_image_resolved.json` (419 resolution records), `scripts/.image_pool.json` (600 pooled entries). No image script was run. The only writes made here were this review's own report artifacts in `backend/reports/audit/`.

1. Executive summary

283 GOOD — preserved	27 LIKELY_WRONG — needs manual review	4 BROKEN_URL — definitive HTTP 400	201 MISSING_BUT_PREVIOUS_URL_AVAILABLE (17 reachable)	218 MISSING_NO_CANDIDATE (199 source-only + 19 nothing)
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Of the 314 foods that currently have an `image_url`, the title/source check kept 283 as **GOOD**, flagged 27 as **LIKELY_WRONG** (title has no overlap with the food name, and/or a non-food keyword), and 4 as **BROKEN_URL**. There are **zero duplicate image URLs** and **zero generic** `Special:FilePath` **placeholders** in the current active catalog.

2. Status classification — definitions & totals

Status	Count	Meaning
GOOD	283	URL present, reachability acceptable, and the matched title shares tokens with the food name.
LIKELY_WRONG	27	URL present but the title has no (or weak) overlap with the food name, or a non-food keyword was found (e.g. "bottle", "palace", "hand").
BROKEN_URL	4	URL returns a definitive HTTP error (4xx).
MISSING_BUT_PREVIOUS_URL_AVAILABLE	201	<code>image_source</code> present, <code>image_url</code> NULL — but a former Pass-1 URL exists in <code>.food_image_results.json</code> .
MISSING_NO_CANDIDATE	218	No recorded URL exists (source-only with no Pass-1 URL, or no source at all).

Reachability sweep: 403 unique URLs probed (314 current + 201 previously assigned). Result: **43 confirmed reachable**, **4 confirmed broken (HTTP 400)**, **356 “unverified” because Wikimedia answered 429 Too Many Requests** — the audit lowered concurrency and retried, but a full re-sweep with a slow, single-threaded pace is recommended later. Foods whose probe was rate-limited were **NOT** classified as broken.

3. The 314 foods that currently have an image

3.1 Suspicious existing images (LIKELY_WRONG) — 27

Title evidence below; none of these were modified.

Food	Matched image title	Score	Non-food hit
Arvi (Colocasia)	Arvis Piziks 2017	0	—
Banana	Bananas by the bunch - Carrara Market (2569636765)	0	market
Bohri Gali Drinks	Limca Bottle, lime soda of India	0	bottle

Food	Matched image title	Score	Non-food hit
Chapati	Baking Chapatis	0	—
Charsi Snacks	Azerbaijan Light snack	0	—
Cherries (Cherry)	Prunus avium fruit	0	—
Dampukht	Pattar ka gosht	0	—
Fort Road Falooda	Khush Mahal or Sitab Khan Palace near Warangal fort in Warangal, Telangana 12	0.33	palace
Gajrella	Gajar Ka Halwa a famous Indian Sweet Dish 01	0	—
GB Mountain Tea	Small cup of green tea	0.33	mall
Hollywood Café Drinks	Mango shakes	0	man
Karadaiyan	Shankarpali sweets mithai Western India 2012	0	—
Kasata	Koderma Kalakand	0	—
Mawa	Mahmoud Al-Mawas	0	—
Pear (Nakh)	Prickly pears	0	—
Pumpkin	Smashing Pumpkins den Atelier,Luxembourg	0	—
Qissa Khwani Snacks	Peshawari Chapli Kabab by Chef Nina	0	—
Rasgulla	Rasgullas from Odisha and Bengal	0	—
Rewri	Gur Rewari (a kind of Gajak) from Lucknow, a traditional Indian snack made with Jaggery and crunchy sesame seeds in the form of crispy bars	0	—
Sindhi Doodh Pak	Chahao kheer	0	—
Sindhi Karel	Haagalakaayi (Kannada- ಹಾಗಲಕಾಯಿ) (6781775067)	0	—
Sindhi Koki	Lachha-paratha	0	—
Sindhi Pedu	Indian Sweet Dessert Peda in a glass plate	0	—
Sindhi Seero	Sooji Halwa (Rava Sheera)	0	—
Tinda (Indian Squash)	Tindas 2017 C1	0	—
Tsot / Gyath	Tandoori Roti in clay oven	0	—
Wazwan Desserts	Phirni at Cool Point, Chandni Chawk	0	hand

3.2 Broken URLs (BROKEN_URL) — 4

Food	Current URL	Reason
Aloo Pulao	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/thumb/4/4e/Plum_juice.jpg/640px-Plum_juice.jpg	url returns HTTP 400 (definitive)
Bihari Kebab	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/thumb/c/c0/Chaaps_and_kebabs.jpg/640px-Chaaps_and_kebabs.jpg	url returns HTTP 400 (definitive)
Mutton Paye	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/thumb/a/a4/Paya_curry_bangladeshi_style.jpg/640px-Paya_curry_bangladeshi_style.jpg	url returns HTTP 400 (definitive)
Sajji Chawal	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/thumb/3/3f/Chicken_sajji.jpg/640px-Chicken_sajji.jpg	url returns HTTP 400 (definitive)

3.3 Confirmed GOOD examples (sample)

Food	Title	Overlap score	URL
Almond (Baadaam)	Home-made almond milk, November 2012	0.5	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/d/de/Home-made_almond_milk%2C_November_2012.jpg
Aloo Gobi	Tapenade and green olives on aloo gobi paratha - Massachusetts	1	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/0/01/Tapenade_and_green_olives_on_aloo_gobi_paratha_-_Massachusetts.jpg
Aloo Kulcha	Amritsari Aloo Kulcha	1	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/d/d7/Amritsari_Aloo_Kulcha.jpg
Aloo Samosa	Aloo samosa - Sri Sai tiffin centre, Gulmohar Park Colony, Serilingampalle - Hyderabad - DSC 0018	1	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/d/d6/Aloo_samosa_-_Sri_Sai_tiffin_centre%2C_Gulmohar_Park_Colony%2C_Serilingampalle_-_Hyderabad_-_DSC_0018.jpg
Aloo Samosa Chaat	Aloo chaat vendor, Connaught Place, New Delhi	0.67	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/8/8e/Aloo_chaat_vendor%2C_Connaught_Place%2C_New_Delhi.jpg
Aloo Tikki Chaat	Produce in Borough Market 2019 (Aloo Tikki Chaat)	1	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/6/6c/Produce_in_Borough_Market_2019_%28Aloo_Tikki_Chaat%29.jpg
Amla (Amla)	Hashim Amla	1	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/d/d7/Hashim_Amla.jpg
Anarsa	Anarsa	1	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/8/86/Anarsa.jpg

Take-away for the new pipeline: the 283 GOOD images must be locked. The new assignment script must treat present + GOOD as immutable unless an explicit curated override says otherwise.

4. The 400 foods with image_source but no image_url

201 still have their former Pass-1 URL inside `.food_image_results.json` → these are **recovery candidates** (URL was stripped out of the database but was recorded). Of those 201, **17 confirmed reachable** now, **1 returns HTTP 400**, and **183 were rate-limited (429) during this sweep** → their recovery viability is “pending verification”. The remaining **199** have a source label but no recorded URL at all → they must be re-searched from scratch.

4.1 Why did these URLs disappear?

No script in `backend/scripts/` writes `image_source` without also setting `image_url` — every writer sets both columns together in one UPDATE. So the 400 source-without-URL rows were almost certainly produced by an **ad-hoc SQL statement / a temporary experiment that was later deleted**, not by any surviving Pass script. The Pass-1 records were also lost from the DB at the same time (that's why the receiver of the URL — `_tmp_resolve_images.js` — found far fewer NULL rows than expected and left 63 rows “needs-review”). This is a data-loss event that predates the current scripts directory.

4.2 Recovery candidates — sample of 201 (pick 12)

Food	Pass-1 previous URL	Reachability probe	Former title
Achari Biryani	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/c/c6/Achari_Biryani.JPG	unverified (429)	Achari Biryani

Food	Pass-1 previous URL	Reachability probe	Former title
Adrak Chai	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/3/3f/Ginger_Tea_%28Adrak_wali_Chai%29.jpg	unverified (429)	Ginger Tea (Adrak wali Chai)
Akki Roti	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/c/c3/Akki_roti.jpg	unverified (429)	Akki roti
Almond	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/d/de/Home-made_almond_milk%2C_November_2012.jpg	reachable	Home-made almond milk, November 2012
Aloo Bukhara Sharbat	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/thumb/4/4e/Plum_juice.jpg/640px-Plum_juice.jpg	fail 400	Aloo Bukhara Sharbat
Aloo Chaat	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/8/8e/Aloo_chaat_vendor%2C_Connaught_Place%2C_New_Delhi.jpg	unverified (429)	Aloo chaat vendor, Connaught Place, New Delhi
Aloo Chawal	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/c/c3/Saloonay_Chawal_With_Aloo_Gosht.JPG	unverified (429)	Saloonay Chawal With Aloo Gosht
Aloo Naan	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/0/01/Amritsari_Aloo_Naan_Thali.jpg	unverified (429)	File:Amritsari Aloo Naan Thali.jpg
Aloo Pakora	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/4/43/Aloo_Pakora_.jpg	unverified (429)	Aloo Pakora
Aloo Paratha	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/0/08/Aloo_paratha.jpg	unverified (429)	Aloo paratha
Aloo Tikki	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/4/40/Aloo_Tikki_Fried_%281%29.JPG	unverified (429)	Aloo Tikki Fried (1)
Amla	https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/d/d7/Hashim_Amla.jpg	reachable	Hashim Amla

Full list is in `food-image-status.csv` (columns `prev_url`, `prev_url_reachable`).

5. The 19 foods with no image and no source

Food	Category
Aloo Chana	Curry & Kebab
Beef Qeema	Curry & Kebab
Besan Ka Chilla	Breakfast
Boiled Eggs	Meat
Chicken Kofta	Curry & Kebab
Chicken Roll	Snacks
Daal Mash	Daal
Desi Omelette	Breakfast
Egg Fried Rice	Rice
Fresh Garden Salad	Vegetable
Fresh Orange Juice	Drinks
Grilled Chicken Breast	Meat
Jeera Rice	Rice

Food	Category
Oatmeal (Milk)	Breakfast
Palak Paneer	Sabzi
Poha (Flattened Rice)	Breakfast
Suji ka Halwa	Dessert
Vanilla Custard	Dessert
Vegetable Pakora	Snacks

These have nothing to recover — the new pipeline's Openverse search runs here first, and low-confidence results are queued for manual review.

6. Recommended architecture — ONE clean image-assignment script

Replace the Pass1–4 + buildImagePool + ad-hoc `_tmp_*` approach with a single, well-structured pipeline built around an explicit, human-reviewable plan. Principles:

- **Never overwrite a GOOD image.** “Has URL + title overlap” = locked.
- **No image-pool token matching.** Do not copy one food's image onto another unless there is an explicit curated mapping.
- **Per-food candidate search** against the Openverse API, then score candidates.
- **Confidence scoring** — every candidate is scored, and only **HIGH** confidence is auto-assigned; everything else goes to a review CSV.

6.1 Pipeline layout

Script	What it does	Writes to DB?
<code>auditFoodImageStatus.js</code>	Read-only classifier (this audit, re-runnable) → status for all 733 foods + reachability sweep with slow throttle.	No
<code>buildImageRecoveryPlan.js</code>	For the 201 former URLs: probe + restore-qualified set; verify; emit <code>recovery-plan.json</code> (approved restore list).	No (dry-run by default)
<code>searchFoodImageCandidates.js</code>	For MISSING_NO_CANDIDATE (218) only: Openverse query per food name → top candidates with license, title, thumb.	No
<code>assignFoodImages.js</code> (rebuilt)	Reads candidates + scoring rules + curated map. AUTO (score ≥ threshold) or QUIET_SKIP for everything else. <code>--apply</code> flag to write; default dry-run prints the diff.	Only with <code>--apply</code>
<code>curated-mappings.json</code>	Held-out human-approved fixes (one <code>food name</code> → { <code>title</code> , <code>url</code> , <code>source</code> } per row) — the ONLY way to reuse another food's image.	—

6.2 Candidate scoring (HIGH = auto)

1. **Food/non-food filter** — reject titles containing strong non-food words (hotel, restaurant, bottle, poster, ...).
2. **Name relevance** — token overlap between food name and image title (≥ 2 tokens or 100% for single-token foods).
3. **Category/description relevance** — title terms match category descriptors (e.g. “sweet”, “curry”, “rice”, “kebab”).
4. **Single-winner rule** — pick the top-scoring candidate; tie → manual.
5. **Reachability gate** — optional post-assignment verification; unreachable → revert + queue for review.
6. Auto-assign only when score ≥ HIGH threshold (e.g. 0.7); everything else → `needs-review.csv`.

6.3 Execution order (all safe, idempotent)

1. Run audit → record baseline (this document is that baseline).
2. Recovery pass for the 201 (restore verified URLs only; keep others in review).
3. Search + auto-assign HIGH confidence for the ~218 with no candidate.
4. Manual review list → `curated-mappings.json` → re-run assign to apply.
5. Re-run audit → verify no GOOD image was changed and every status moved to GOOD/REVIEW.

7. Deliverables produced by this audit

File	Contents
<code>reports/audit/audit-summary.json</code>	All 733 foods with full classification, flags, previous URL, probe results (machine-readable).
<code>reports/audit/food-image-status.csv</code>	Same data flattened to CSV (one row per food).
<code>reports/audit/_reach.json</code>	Raw per-URL reachability probe results.

Constraint checklist (all honoured): no Pass script executed · no database write · no `Pass5/Pass6` created · no temporary

script left in `scripts/` · all current GOOD images preserved · no image copied from one food to another.